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LARGE The Mad Cantor of Frosthollow

A Fate's Edge OneShot of Joy, Dread, and Winter

Folk Horror Multiple Patrons Social Ritual Play

largeADVENTURE OVERVIEW

@ll **Premise:** Frosthollow's solstice rite, the Feast of the Endless Night, has curdled

Theme: Folk Horror

Focus: Social Ritual Play

Combat: Low Combat Optional

Length: OneShot

largePREMISE TONE

Frosthollow's solstice rite, the Feast of the Endless Night, has curdled. The village cantor, Dara Nightweaver, wears a living crown of holly and sings with a voice not wholly hers. Revelers decorate with bloodbright berries and do not sleep. Three Powers lean in: Thrysos (ecstasy and excess), the Pale Shepherd (thresholds and the passage), and the Silent Choir (mercy through silence).

PCs arrive as storm and song rise together. Their choices decide whether Frosthollow remembers joyor becomes its grave.

largeHOOK

Offer three clear entries:

tem **Shelter in a Storm:** Snow closes behind; bells peal offrhythm. tem **A Missing Brother:** A hunter's letter begs you to fetch him from the Feast. tem **Ritual Competence:** A nearby abbot sends you to audit a troubled solstice mass.

largeFRONTS TIMERS

Holly Crown's Hold [6] Advances when Dara sings unopposed or offerings are made.

tem **12:** Subtle compulsion (1d to resist revelry) tem **34:** 1 Position near the square
tem **56:** Crown roots through flesh; Dara becomes Avatar of Revel

Village Hysteria [6] Advances when the ^{bepage} party indulges, delays, or escalates spectacle.

tem **12:** Harmless mania tem **34:** Harm 1 from exposure/exhaustion tem **56:** Stampede, collapse, or freezing injuries (Harm 2)

Storm's Mercy [4] Advances on time passage or failed shelter efforts.

tem **1:** Whiteout pockets tem **2:** Paths vanish tem **3:** Avalanches threaten tem **4:** Outlying homes cut off (people die without aid)

Silent Choir Mandate [4] Advances when harm spreads or pleas for rest go unheard.

tem **4:** Choir imposes Great Silencespeech fails in the square until the rite is resolved

largeCONDITIONS ENVIRONMENTAL MOVES

Revelry Condition You feel wonderful. 1d to resist joining songs, dances, or feasts; ignoring an invitation advances Hysteria. Cleansed by cold immersion, fasting, or a counterhymn.

Winter Moves

tem **Whiteout** tem **Black Ice** tem **RoofLoad Collapse** tem **BoneChill Seep** (Harm 1)
tem **Lost Lanterns** (separate the party) tem **Avalanche Shadow** (timer tick + forced scramble)

largeCORE SCENES

1. Arrival: Snow, Smoke, Holly

Read: Frosthollow's square blazes with lanterns; offkey choirs bellow carols. A crown of holly gleams wetly on the cantor's brow. The bells are late. The storm inhales.

Moves Challenges

tem **Assess the Rite:** Lore + Insight DV 3 learn the hymn is miskeyed to force breath patterns (+1 SB to GM if ignored) tem **Resist the Cheer:** Resolve DV 2 on a miss, gain Revelry tem **Shepherd the Elderly to Shelter:** Command + Athletics DV 3 on a hit, reduce Storm's Mercy

2. The Bell Tower Greta's Truth

Read: Greta Frostwhisper, trembling in the belfry, clutches a ledger of the old hymn. "They changed the breathing. Too long. Too fast. They'll fall and never rise."

Moves Challenges

tem **Compare Hymns:** Lore + Craft DV 3 identify a counterrefrain that resets breathing safely tem **Befriend Greta:** Sway + Presence DV 2 gain a trusted guide; +1d on village social rolls

3. Dara's House The Red Thread

Read: Holly cuttings root in bowls; old lyrics are crossed out; a red thread binds prayer-knots to a goblet.

Moves Challenges

tem **Unravel the Charm:** Arcana + Tinker DV 4 separate the goblet (Thrysos vessel) from the holly. On partial, advance Holly Crown's Hold tem **Quiet the Home:** Shepherd's Bargain accept a memory tithe to sanctify this space (Choir 1 this scene)

4. Climax: Feast of the Endless Night

Read: Dara raises her hands; the village inhales as one. Snow becomes confetti. The bells strike late.

Moves Challenges Choose one or braid them:

tem **CounterHymn:** Presence + Sway DV 4 lead a new refrain; on success, reduce Hysteria by 2, stabilize breath; on miss, Holly Hold +1 and Choir advances tem **Sunder the Crown:** Melee/Arcana + Athletics DV 4 break holly roots; on partial, take Harm 1 (thorns/acid sap) tem **Triune Negotiation:** name each Patron's concession: Insight + Lore DV 5 forge a pact: short feast, long rest, and a hymn of remembrance. On hit, all timers freeze; on miss, one Patron takes primacy (GM move)

largeOUTCOMES

Resolutions

tem **Mercy Kept (Best):** Feast becomes vigil; the storm parts; Dara lives, crown withers. PCs gain 2 Boons (Community/Thresholds) tem **Joy Saved but Costly:** Revelry quiets; 12 deaths; Dara scarred. PCs gain 1 Boon; choose: spare a life or spare a memory tem **Silence Falls (Grim):** Silent Choir imposes Great Silence; Feast ends forever. PCs gain Favor with the Choir; village loses its song tem **Rapture Eternal (Dark):** Thrysos claims the square; Frosthollow dances into legend. PCs marked with Revelry until exorcised

largeDARA AS AVATAR (IF THE CROWN CONSUMES)

Dara, Avatar of Revel **Tags:** Elite, Mythic Song, Zone Control

Aura Crescendo: Each round, all in the square test Resolve DV 3 or gain/advance Revelry

SongStrike: Presence + Arcana vs. the crowd; on hit, split Harm 2 (breathless) among up to three targets

Roots of Holly: On melee hit against Dara, attacker tests Wits DV 2 or be Entangled

Weakness: Counterhymn sung by a beloved voice (Greta or a PC who earned the choir's trust) reduces her Position by one step this round

largeGM DIALS TOOLS

GM Dials Options

tem **Patron Prominence:** Feature 1, 2, or all 3. For oneshot pace, lead with Thrysos, let Shepherd save, let Choir judge tem **Combat Light or Heavy:** Swap Sunder the Crown to a pure ritual (Arcana + Insight) or to a brawl in the choir

loft tem **Hard Mode:** Add Breath Debt: each failed Revelry resist deals Harm 1 (asphyxia) that only the counterhymn heals tem **Mechanical Rewards:** If Mercy Wins: +1d on future Comfort/Recovery scenes. If Rapture Tempted: bank 1 Joy Tokencash for +1d on one grand celebration later

largeTREASURE FALLOUT

Holly Circlet (Relic) Once/session: Turn a crowd from fear to festivity (+1d to mass morale). Each use risks Revelry. Cleansed if crowned with snowwater at dawn.

Greta's Ledger of Hymns Advantage (+1d) to Ritual Audit checks; reveals miskeyed breath patterns used for crowd control.

Casting the Patrons (Optional Flavor)

tem **Thrysos:** Laughing hearthgod turned too loud; smells of cider and iron; color over truth tem **Pale Shepherd:** A lantern across snow; speaks in exchanged memories; never hurries tem **Silent Choir:** Frosthaze in candlelight; mercy as cessation; demands quiet means consent

largeQUICK START FOR PCs

tem **Runekeeper (Thresholds):** Bargain with the Shepherd for safe passage; pay in story or scar tem **Cantor / Bard:** Compose the counterhymn; lead callandresponse to cleanse Revelry tem **Sellsword:** Guard the bell ropes; hold the square against stampede or falling ice tem **Healer:** Replace Cheer with Breathsynchronized breathing drills under the eaves

"When the song is too sweet to end, mercy is a hard hand on the bell rope."

Greta Frostwhisper